

General Paper

Paper 1

* Introduction

1. Introduce the topic with an interesting opening, and explain.
 - ↳ Quotation
 - ↳ Event
 - ↳ Incident in history
2. Establishing the context.
 - ↳ Bring in a world trend / issue / controversy.
3. Clarify key terms.
 - ↳ Attack the question
 - ↳ Limit the scope of the question to only the specific points discussed in the essay.
4. Thesis statement.
 - ↳ Stand
 - ↳ Main arguments
 - ↳ Opposing viewpoints & Rebuttal
5. Re-emphasis on stand!

* Body (T.E.E.C.C.)

1. Topic sentence
 - ↳ Main point + Consequences
 - * Must be broad, NOT example driven!
2. Explanation / Elaboration
 - ↳ Development of main point
 - ↳ Set up for example
3. Example
 - ↳ No narrative e.g.
 - ↳ Do not explain the e.g., instead, analyse its relevance to point

4. Counterargument and Rebuttal

→ Raise a fair and reasonable opposing viewpoint then rebutting it

→ Put examples here

→ Bring in Theories of Morality to substantiate *Use in conclusion too

→ Deontology: Judgement based on actions rather than its consequences.

→ Consequentialism: Judgement based on the consequence rather than ~~the~~ the actions leading to it.

→ Cultural relativism: Belief that whether an action is right or wrong depends on the particular set of principles held by the relevant culture at that point in time.

We cannot criticise the actions of those in other cultures other than our own.

Deontology: ... are inherently wrong regardless of any tangential positive consequences it brings as ...

Consequentialism: ... may spark dire consequences which outweigh the initial benefits ...

Cultural relativism: ... is hard to define.

It would be difficult to come up with a precise yardstick to measure ... as it largely depends on one's upbringing and cultures.

5. Concluding statement

→ Link back to question

Conclusion

1. Summary

→ Reiterate main points

2. Analyse the question further (Synthesis)

→ Attack "unsure" parts of the question

→ Add more nuance to essay

3. Thought-provoking and insightful ending

→ Provide sense of closure

Short Answer Questions

1. Literary devices

Metaphors : Just as (metaphor) is ... , (target) is also ...

Irony : It is expected that (situation) will lead to (expectation) yet the (outcome) is ...

Paradox : It seems contradictory that (paradox). However, it reflects reality as ...

2. Punctuation

Inverted commas : • The author does not truly think that '... are ...

• Apply to some but not the others

OR
• The wider public might think that the term " " is normal, but the author disagrees as

• Pun / Word play he probably thinks that such labels are

Ellipsis : • Repeated cycle

OR

• Endless list

OR

• Ending in suspense

Bold : Emphasis in relation to other words

Italics : * Answers must reflect that italicization implies a subtle criticism of status quo!

Parenthesis : • Additional information (clarification or personal view)

OR

• Context to justify the author's assertion

3. Literal questions

Questions with "Use your own words as far as possible"

* Over-deliver ⇒ Give as many points as possible

4. Attitude / Tone

The author has a (degree) (attitude / tone) towards (context).

This can be inferred from ...

Positive:

- Sympathetic
- Approving of
- Optimistic

Neutral:

- Ambivalent
(having mixed feelings)
- Apathetic
(showing no interest or concern)

Negative:

- Aggressive
(hostile, forceful)
- Aggrieved
(indignant, disgruntled)
- Bitter / Resentful
(Unhappy or hateful towards)
- Condescending
(superior to)
- Frustrated
- Incredulous
(hard to believe)
- Critical
(Finding fault)
- Cynical
(Believing the worse)
- Repressing
- Disapproving
of
- Dismissive / Scornful
(unworthy / insignificant of)
- Mocking
- Sarcastic
- Skeptical

Opening question:

The author poses the question to introduce the issue / capture the readers' attention.

Concluding statement question:

Provide an answer to opening question

OR

Provide a succinct / comprehensive conclusion to (context)

5. General inference

Summary

* 17 ~ 23 points

ASAP strategy

→ Analyze question requirements

- What to summarise

→ Select only relevant information

- Exclude IRE (irrelevant points, repetitions, examples)
- Underline / highlight points to summarise

→ Assemble points based on question requirements

- Signposting using connectors / commas

→ Paraphrase

* Try not to paraphrase word by word. Read the entire sentence first!

Application Question

Introduction

- ↳ Overview of ideas raised by author in the passage
 - Points that the AA response will cover
- ↳ Relate to Singapore context
 - Relevant facts / characteristics / factors of SG
 - Asian conservative
 - Aging population
 - Meritocratic
 - Mult-racial / religious / cultural
 - Open economy
- ↳ State overall stand
 - Wording must be taken from question

Body

- ↳ Summarise / paraphrase the author's views, stand and ideas
- ↳ Quote
- ↳ Explain the quote
 - Why does the author say this?

Sentence structures

- (writer) highlights/emphasises ...
- In the passage, (writer) explores / discusses / considers ...
- (writer) offers possible views about how ...
- In my society, ...
- With (issue) gaining prevalence in my society, it is becoming increasingly relevant to consider ...
- In view of Singapore's particular circumstances, ...
- The discussion of (issue) must take into account uniquely Singaporean constraints such as ...
- Given this, (writer)'s arguments on (issue) are applicable to my society.
- As such, I agree with the author's views/observation insofar as (conclusion or context that applies).

- The writer states / posits / argues that ...
- According to the author, ...
- This point of view is found in ...
- This assertion can be found in ...
- Here, the author's conviction is that ...
- What this means is ...

↳ Stand

- I find the author's argument convincing applicable / relevant ...
- To me, the author's argument is true relevant / applicable to my society in the sense that ...
- Based on (factor / trend / context) in my society, I find the author's point relevant / irrelevant.

↳ Explain your stand

→ Explain factor / condition / trend / context

- This is because in Singapore ...
- The reasons behind this is that ...

↳ Factual evidence

→ Events / opinions / statistics

→ Who / What / When / Where / Why / How

- Consider the situation ...
- This is evidenced by ...
- This is clearly seen in the ...

↳ Link evidence to stand

- Such incidents / examples demonstrate ...
- This exemplifies ...

↳ Evaluate example

→ How the example is part of a long-term trend in Singapore

Relevant:

- Such situations are not an exception to Singapore. The ... This shows that (point) is a pertinent and ongoing concern.
- A modern society like Singapore lends itself to such happenings because (SG feature) mirroring the author's point.

Macro evaluation:

- These developments are part of a recent trend / long history where ...
- The fact that (SG feature) signals that such examples will continue to be the norm / frequent in my society.

Irrelevant:

- Singapore is unlikely to experience what the author described as (SG feature).

↳ Conclusion

- In view of these factors, I feel that it is only logical to conclude ...

• Therefore, in the Singapore context ...